

Linux+ Command Cheat Sheet

■ File & Directory Commands

Command	Description	Example
ls	List files and directories	ls -l
cd	Change directory	cd /home
pwd	Print current directory	pwd
mkdir	Create directory	mkdir testdir
rm	Remove file	rm file.txt
cp	Copy files	cp file1 file2 /tmp/
mv	Move or rename file	mv old.txt new.txt
cat	Show file content	cat file.txt
touch	Create empty file	touch newfile.txt

■ System Information

Command	Description	Example
uname -a	Show kernel and system info	uname -a
hostnamectl	Display hostname info	hostnamectl
df -h	Disk usage (human-readable)	df -h
du -sh /home	Directory size	du -sh /home
free -h	Memory usage	free -h
lscpu	CPU information	lscpu
uptime	System uptime	uptime
top	Display running processes	top

■ User & Permissions

Command	Description	Example
whoami	Current user	whoami
id	User info	id yasser
adduser	Create user	sudo adduser john
passwd	Change password	passwd john
chmod	Change permissions	chmod 755 file.sh
chown	Change file owner	chown root:root file.txt
sudo	Run command as root	sudo apt update

usermod	Modify user	sudo usermod -aG sudo john
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■ Networking

Command	Description	Example
ip a	Display IP addresses	ip a
ping	Check connectivity	ping google.com
curl	Fetch web content	curl https://example.com
wget	Download file	wget http://file.com/test.zip
ss -tuln	Show open ports	ss -tuln
netstat -tulnp	List listening ports	netstat -tulnp
traceroute	Trace network route	traceroute google.com
dig	DNS lookup	dig example.com

■■ Process Management

Command	Description	Example
ps aux	List processes	ps aux
kill PID	Terminate process	kill 1234
pkill name	Kill process by name	pkill firefox
top	Monitor live processes	top
jobs	Show background jobs	jobs
bg	Resume background job	bg %1
fg	Bring job to foreground	fg %1

■ Search & Filters

Command	Description	Example
find	Search for files	find / -name file.txt
grep	Search text patterns	grep 'error' log.txt
locate	Find files by name	locate passwd
sort	Sort lines	sort names.txt
uniq	Remove duplicates	uniq list.txt
awk	Pattern scanning	awk '{print \$1}' file.txt
sed	Stream editor	sed 's/old/new/g' file.txt

■ Package Management

Command	Description	Example
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apt update	Update repositories	sudo apt update
apt install	Install package	sudo apt install nmap
apt remove	Remove package	sudo apt remove apache2
dpkg -l	List installed packages	dpkg -l
yum install	Install package (RHEL)	sudo yum install httpd

■ ■ Archiving & Compression

Command	Description	Example
tar -cvf	Create tar archive	tar -cvf archive.tar file1 file2
tar -xvf	Extract tar archive	tar -xvf archive.tar
gzip	Compress file	gzip file.txt
gunzip	Decompress file	gunzip file.txt.gz
zip	Create zip archive	zip files.zip *.txt
unzip	Extract zip	unzip files.zip

■ Disk & Mount

Command	Description	Example
mount	Mount device	mount /dev/sdb1 /mnt
umount	Unmount device	umount /mnt
lsblk	List block devices	lsblk
blkid	List UUIDs	blkid
fdisk -l	List partitions	sudo fdisk -l

■ System Management

Command	Description	Example
systemctl	Manage systemd services	sudo systemctl status ssh
journalctl	View logs	journalctl -xe
shutdown now	Shutdown system	sudo shutdown now
reboot	Reboot system	sudo reboot
history	Command history	history
date	Display date/time	date
cal	Display calendar	cal

■ Filesystem Hierarchy (FHS)

Command	Description	Example
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/	Root directory	ls /
/bin	Essential binaries	ls /bin
/etc	System configuration files	ls /etc
/home	User home directories	ls /home
/var	Variable data (logs, mail)	ls /var
/tmp	Temporary files	ls /tmp
/usr	User programs	ls /usr
/dev	Device files	ls /dev
/opt	Optional packages	ls /opt
/lib	Shared libraries	ls /lib